

DESIGN DOCUMENT

COS 301 - Capstone 2026

Capstone Project: EquityLens

By The Big Five

Field	Detail
Project Name	EquityLens
Client	Amazon Web Services (AWS)
Team	The Big Five (TB5)
Module	COS 301 - Software Engineering
Version	1.0
Last updated	22 May 2026

Name	Student Number
Abdulrahman Sabah(Team Lead)	u24566170
Joshua Heath	u23541475
Antony van Straten	u24590739
Jonty Honey	u23536862

Contents

1. Introduction.....	3
2. Colour Palette	3
3. Typography	7
4. Logo and Iconography.....	8
5. Spacing System.....	9
6. UI Component Styling.....	10
7. Design Principles.....	14
8. Accessibility Standards.....	15
9. Responsive Breakpoints.....	16
10. Animation and Motion.....	17

1. Introduction

This Brand Style Guide defines the visual identity and design standards for the EquityLens platform. All developers and designers must adhere to these guidelines when implementing any user-facing component.

2. Colour Palette

Primary Colours

Name	HEX	RGB	Usage
Midnight Black	#0A0A0A	rgb(10, 10, 10)	Primary background, nav bar, headers
Golden Yellow	#FFB800	rgb(255, 184, 0)	Primary accent, CTAs, highlights, active states
Pure White	#FFFFFF	rgb(255, 255, 255)	Primary text on dark backgrounds, icons

Secondary Colours

Name	HEX	RGB	Usage
Dark Surface	#1A1A1A	rgb(26, 26, 26)	Card backgrounds, sidebar, secondary surfaces
Mid Grey	#2C2C2C	rgb(44, 44, 44)	Borders, dividers, input backgrounds
Light Grey	#6B6B6B	rgb(107, 107, 107)	Placeholder text, disabled states, captions
Subtle Grey	#F5F5F5	rgb(245, 245, 245)	Light mode background, table row alternates

Semantic Colours

Name	HEX	RGB	Usage
Success Green	#22C55E	rgb(34, 197, 94)	Positive returns, success states, upward trends
Danger Red	#EF4444	rgb(239, 68, 68)	Negative returns, errors, downward trends
Warning Amber	#F59E0B	rgb(245, 158, 11)	Warnings, moderate risk indicators
Info Blue	#3B82F6	rgb(59, 130, 246)	Informational states, tooltips, links

Theme Tokens

These are the CSS variables to be used throughout the codebase:

```
:root {  
  /* Backgrounds */  
  
  --bg-primary: #0A0A0A;  
  --bg-secondary: #1A1A1A;  
  --bg-tertiary: #2C2C2C;  
  --bg-card: #1A1A1A;  
  
  /* Text */  
  
  --text-primary: #FFFFFF;  
  --text-secondary: #6B6B6B;  
  --text-muted: #4B4B4B;  
  
  /* Accent */  
  
  --accent-primary: #FFB800;  
  --accent-hover: #E5A600;
```

```
--accent-subtle: rgba(255, 184, 0, 0.1);
```

```
/* Semantic */
```

```
--color-success: #22C55E;
```

```
--color-danger: #EF4444;
```

```
--color-warning: #F59E0B;
```

```
--color-info: #3B82F6;
```

```
/* Border */
```

```
--border-default: #2C2C2C;
```

```
--border-accent: #FFB800;
```

```
/* Shadow */
```

```
--shadow-card: 0 4px 6px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4);
```

```
--shadow-modal: 0 20px 60px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.6);
```

```
--text-ghost: #3A3A3A;
```

```
--border-subtle: #1F1F1F;
```

```
}
```

```
/* Light mode overrides */
```

```
[data-theme="light"] {
```

```
--bg-card: #FFFFFF;
```

```
--text-ghost: #9B9B9B;
```

```
--border-subtle: #ECECEC;
```

```
--bg-primary: #F5F5F5;
```

```
--bg-secondary: #FFFFFF;
```

```
--bg-tertiary: #E5E5E5;
```

```
--bg-card: #FFFFFF;
```

```
--text-primary: #0A0A0A;  
--text-secondary: #6B6B6B;  
--border-default: #E5E5E5;  
--shadow-card: 0 4px 6px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.08);  
}
```

Accessibility - Contrast Ratios

All colour combinations must meet WCAG AA standard minimum contrast ratio of 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text.

3. Typography

Font Families

Role	Font	Fallback	Usage
Primary	Inter	system-ui, sans-serif	All body text, UI elements
Monospace	JetBrains Mono	Courier New, monospace	Code snippets, ticker symbols, numerical data

Type Scale

Name	Size	Weight	Line Height	Usage
Display	48px / 3rem	700	1.1	Hero headings, landing page
H1	36px / 2.25rem	700	1.2	Page titles
H2	28px / 1.75rem	600	1.3	Section headings
H3	22px / 1.375rem	600	1.4	Card titles, sub-sections
H4	18px / 1.125rem	500	1.4	Widget titles, labels
Body Large	16px / 1rem	400	1.6	Primary body text
Body	14px / 0.875rem	400	1.6	Secondary body text, descriptions
Small	12px / 0.75rem	400	1.5	Captions, metadata, badges
Micro	10px / 0.625rem	500	1.4	Labels, tags
Mono	14px / 0.875rem	400	1.5	Ticker symbols, numerical values

4. Logo and Iconography

Logo

- The Big Five (TB5) logo consists of an African acacia tree silhouette inside a circular black background with golden yellow accent tones.
- Usage Rules:
- Minimum size: 32px × 32px
- Always maintain aspect ratio - never stretch or distort
- Clear space: maintain a minimum clear space equal to the height of the tree silhouette on all sides
- Always use on a contrasting background - black logo on white, white/gold logo on dark

Approved Variations:

Variation	Background	Usage
Full colour (gold on black)	Dark backgrounds	Primary usage, navbar
Inverted (black on white)	Light backgrounds	Light mode, print
Monochrome white	Dark photography	Overlays
Icon only (no text)	Any	Favicon, small spaces

Iconography

- Use Lucide React as the primary icon library. It is already compatible with React and provides consistent, clean line icons.
- npm install lucide-react
- Icon Usage Rules:
- Default size: 20px × 20px
- Small: 16px × 16px
- Large: 24px × 24px
- Stroke width: 1.5px for default, 2px for emphasis
- Always pair icons with a text label unless space is severely constrained
- Icon colour should match the surrounding text colour or use --accent-primary for interactive icons

5. Spacing System

Use an 8px base spacing unit. All spacing values should be multiples of 4px or 8px.

Token	Value	Usage
space-1	4px	Micro spacing, icon gaps
space-2	8px	Tight spacing, small padding
space-3	12px	Compact padding
space-4	16px	Default padding, card inner
space-5	20px	Section spacing
space-6	24px	Card padding, form groups
space-8	32px	Section padding
space-10	40px	Large section gaps
space-12	48px	Page padding
space-16	64px	Major section breaks

6. UI Component Styling

Buttons

Primary Button

- Background: #FFB800
- Text: #0A0A0A
- Border: none
- Border radius: 8px
- Padding: 10px 20px
- Font size: 14px
- Font weight: 600
- Hover: background #E5A600
- Active: background #CC9400
- Disabled: opacity 0.4, cursor not-allowed

Secondary Button

- Background: transparent
- Text: #FFB800
- Border: 1px solid #FFB800
- Border radius: 8px
- Padding: 10px 20px
- Font size: 14px
- Font weight: 600
- Hover: background rgba(255, 184, 0, 0.1)

Ghost Button

- Background: transparent
- Text: #FFFFFF
- Border: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Border radius: 8px
- Padding: 10px 20px
- Font size: 14px
- Font weight: 500
- Hover: background #1A1A1A

Danger Button

- Background: #EF4444
- Text: #FFFFFF
- Border: none
- Border radius: 8px
- Padding: 10px 20px
- Font size: 14px
- Font weight: 600
- Hover: background #DC2626

Input Fields

- Background: #1A1A1A
- Text: #FFFFFF
- Placeholder: #6B6B6B
- Border: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Border radius: 8px
- Padding: 10px 14px
- Font size: 14px
- Focus border: 1px solid #FFB800
- Focus outline: none
- Focus box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(255, 184, 0, 0.15)
- Error border: 1px solid #EF4444
- Error box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.15)

Cards

- Background: #1A1A1A
- Border: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Border radius: 12px
- Padding: 24px
- Box shadow: 0 4px 6px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4)
- Hover shadow: 0 8px 16px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.6)

Navigation Bar

- Background: #0A0A0A
- Border bottom: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Height: 64px
- Padding: 0 24px
- Logo size: 32px
- Nav link colour: #6B6B6B

- Nav link active colour: #FFFFFF
- Nav link hover colour: #FFB800

Sidebar

- Background: #0A0A0A
- Border right: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Width: 240px (expanded), 64px (collapsed)
- Padding: 16px
- Item padding: 10px 12px
- Item border radius: 8px
- Item colour: #6B6B6B
- Item active background: rgba(255, 184, 0, 0.1)
- Item active colour: #FFB800
- Item hover background: #1A1A1A

Modals

- Overlay: rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.7)
- Background: #1A1A1A
- Border: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Border radius: 16px
- Padding: 32px
- Max width: 560px
- Box shadow: 0 20px 60px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.6)

Tables

- Header background: #1A1A1A
- Header text: #6B6B6B
- Header font size: 12px
- Header font weight: 600
- Header letter spacing: 0.05em
- Row background: transparent
- Row alternate background: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.02)
- Row hover background: rgba(255, 184, 0, 0.05)
- Cell padding: 12px 16px
- Cell font size: 14px
- Border bottom: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Positive value colour: #22C55E
- Negative value colour: #EF4444
- Badges and Tags

- Border radius: 9999px (pill)
- Padding: 2px 10px
- Font size: 12px
- Font weight: 500

Success: background rgba(34, 197, 94, 0.1), text #22C55E, border 1px solid rgba(34, 197, 94, 0.2)

Danger: background rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.1), text #EF4444, border 1px solid rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.2)

Warning: background rgba(245, 158, 11, 0.1), text #F59E0B, border 1px solid rgba(245, 158, 11, 0.2)

Info: background rgba(59, 130, 246, 0.1), text #3B82F6, border 1px solid rgba(59, 130, 246, 0.2)

Neutral: background #2C2C2C, text #6B6B6B

Charts (Recharts)

- Background: transparent
- Grid lines: #2C2C2C
- Axis text: #6B6B6B
- Axis font size: 12px
- Tooltip background: #1A1A1A
- Tooltip border: 1px solid #2C2C2C
- Tooltip text: #FFFFFF

Chart colour palette (in order):

1. #FFB800 - Golden Yellow (primary)
2. #3B82F6 - Blue
3. #22C55E - Green
4. #EF4444 - Red
5. #8B5CF6 - Purple
6. #F59E0B - Amber
7. #06B6D4 - Cyan

7. Design Principles

1. Clarity First - Every element on screen must serve a purpose. Financial data is complex - the interface must make it simple. Avoid decorative elements that add visual noise without informational value.
2. Consistency - Use the same component for the same purpose everywhere. Buttons, inputs, cards, and typography must behave and look identically across all screens.
3. Responsiveness - All layouts must function correctly on desktop (1280px+), tablet (768px-1279px), and mobile (320px-767px). No horizontal scrolling on mobile.
4. Accessibility - All interactive elements must be keyboard navigable. All colour combinations must meet WCAG AA contrast standards. All images must have alt text. Screen reader compatibility is required.
5. Feedback - Every user action must produce visible feedback. Loading states, success messages, and error messages must always be present.
6. Data Density - Financial dashboards need to show a lot of data. Prioritise information density without sacrificing clarity. Use compact spacing in data tables while maintaining generous spacing in forms and marketing sections.

8. Accessibility Standards

WCAG Compliance

The platform must meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards at minimum.

Requirements

Colour

- Never use colour as the only means of conveying information
- All text must meet minimum contrast ratios (4.5:1 normal, 3:1 large)
- Keyboard Navigation
- All interactive elements must be reachable via Tab key
- Focus states must be clearly visible - use outline: 2px solid #FFB800
- Modal dialogs must trap focus while open
- Escape key must close modals and dropdowns

Screen Readers

- All images must have descriptive alt attributes
- All form inputs must have associated <label> elements
- All charts must have a text alternative or data table
- Use ARIA roles and labels where semantic HTML is insufficient

Motion

- Respect prefers-reduced-motion - disable animations for users who prefer reduced motion
- No auto-playing animations that flash more than 3 times per second

9. Responsive Breakpoints

Name	Breakpoint	Usage
Mobile	320px - 639px	Single column layouts
Tablet	640px - 1023px	Two column layouts, collapsed sidebar
Desktop	1024px+	Full layout, expanded sidebar

/ TailwindCSS breakpoints already configured */*

sm: 640px

md: 768px

lg: 1024px

xl: 1280px

2xl: 1536px

10. Animation and Motion

Principles:

- Animations should be purposeful - they communicate state changes, not decoration
- Duration: 150ms for micro interactions, 300ms for page transitions, 500ms maximum for complex animations
- Easing: use ease-out for elements entering the screen, ease-in for elements leaving

Standard transitions:

```
/* Default transition for interactive elements */
```

```
transition: all 150ms ease-out;
```

```
/* Page transitions */
```

```
transition: opacity 300ms ease-out, transform 300ms ease-out;
```

```
/* Reduced motion */
```

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
```

```
  * {
```

```
    animation-duration: 0.01ms !important;
```

```
    transition-duration: 0.01ms !important;
```

```
  }
```

```
}
```